SpeechGeek



Season Eight: Winter 2011

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The Geek and Mrs. Geek have had a busy two months since the release of our Season Eight: Fall 2010 issue.

You see, we welcomed the newest forensicator to our family: Elliott. He may only be eight weeks old, but it seems that he already has the booming voice and screaming of a future Dramatic Interp all-star.

Based on the way I smile when I see him, maybe he'd be better suited for H.I. rounds?

Maybe he won't even like forensics--though I highly doubt that.

While every season is a new adventure, this one has been even more so around the SpeechGeek HQ. Becuase of our new addition, this second issue wraps Season Eight.

Don't worry, though, as there's still a lot of great stuff in store for you before Nationals 2011 in Dallas!

Corey Alderdice
Publisher

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Hypothetically Yours

by Katie Newport

(Brian knocks on door, and Jeremy answers it.)

BRIAN. Hey, Jeremy.

JEREMY. Hey, Brian. Linda's not here right now... She should be back in maybe ten, fifteen minutes if you wanted to come back then.

BRIAN. *(lets himself in)* It's fine, I'll just wait here. I needed to talk to you, anyway.

JEREMY. *(closes door after a beat)* Sorry, but I'm actually kind of busy. I've got a lot of--

BRIAN. *(not paying attention)* Jeremy, can I ask you a question?

JEREMY. No.

BRIAN. Because I.... Wait. What?

JEREMY. No, you may not ask me a question.

BRIAN. But... Why not? I really need your help.

JEREMY. I'm sorry, but I cannot allow myself to "help" you again. You know what happened last time.

BRIAN. Oh, come on, Jeremy. We've known each other since high school, before I even started dating your sister. You can't let one little thing-

JEREMY. One little thing? That's a bit of an understatement, don't you think?

BRIAN. You're making this a bigger deal than it needs to be. I mean, that was so long ago that I can barely even remember what happened.

JEREMY. Oh? Let me take you back about two-and-a-half years ago. The location: this very living room.

BRIAN. Jeremy-

JEREMY. I was all dressed up, getting ready for a date. Then you suddenly burst through the door, begging for help and advice.

BRIAN. Are you done now?

JEREMY. *(ignoring him)* Jeremy! I need your help and advice! I want to take Linda to Hawaii for our five-year anniversary—did you know it's been five years since we started dating?--but I can't decide on the best mode of transportation and it is only four months away! Should I buy plane tickets or would a cruise be better?' Then we pro ceeded to go through what could hypothetically happen in each situation.

BRIAN. You can't possibly be blaming that on me.

JEREMY. Long story short, we ended up hypothetically stranded on a hypothetical island where, hypothetically, there was no food. This was, of course, after our hypothetical plane hypothetically crashed due to the hypothetical bird that flew into the hypothetical engine.

BRIAN. Jeremy! That was ages ago. And nothing that bad actually hap pened--

JEREMY. Brian, my date was ticked because I was late to pick her up.

How to Do Nothing...

by Clint Snyder

(Ricky, one of the head managers at MallMart, greets the newest employee and tells him how things work around the store-they don't.)

Welcome aboard the Mall-mart crew. I'm Ricky, your supervisor, and I'm gonna show you the ropes around here, while having lots of fun doing it. The most important rule here is always look busy. One good rule of thumb is to never put your hands in your pockets. People with their hands in their pockets might look like they're not doing anything. Personally, it helps me to put sharp objects like tacks or knives in my pocket. The scars are like little personal reminders etched into your flesh. If you really wanna get creative put some poisonous animals in there. Nothing says you care about quality quite like than trip to the emergency room. Another important tip is to say "ten-four," to your coworkers and anyone else around you. It makes you seem alert and like you know what you're talking about…ten-four… See what I mean?

Now if a customer ever asks you anything, the only answer you should ever give is, "I'll check in the back." It gives them the impression that you're listening and that you care about they want. For example, if a customer were to ask, "Do you have anymore of these stupid ceramic parrots?" "I'll check in the back." "Where is the bathroom?" " I'll check in the back." "You're not listening to a word I'm saying, I want to speak with your supervisor." "I'll check in the back." It works every time and gives you an excuse to go the break room. If someone catches you in the break room, just say, "I had finished all my work so quickly that I thought I might take the opportunity to clean up the break room." Ten- four.

Now, hypothetically, assume you forgot to eat breakfast and it's still three hours 'til your lunch. What do you do? Take a trip down the cereal aisle. Look here: this box has free gluten in it. I don't know what gluten means, but it's probably German for delicious and uh-oh. *(knocks box over)* Some careless customer has knocked the box all over the floor. Walla! Breakfast is served. You can eat it right off the floor to because your gullible coworkers are actually working and just cleaned the floor. *(laughs to self)*

Your work here is very similar to that of a government employee. You have to do as little work as possible over a period of eight hours, while looking productive doing it. This can get kind of boring. One way to pass the time is to head to the pet department and set up a fighting tank for the beta fish. Take bets on the winner; you'll earn a little extra cash on the side. Our current champion is Jose the Whale. Rumor has it that he was genetically modified at beta shipping yard in Mexico City.

We also have a driving range set up in our sporting goods department. A lot of

times the balls fly over and hit old ladies in the fabrics department. It's a good thing, you know, they usually get some sort of head injury. Then there're less customers to ask you questions.

One of the big hassles of working at MallMart is moving carts to the cart coral in the parking lot. You can, however, easily get rid of this problem by getting rid of the carts. There's a creek in back of the store. Just chuck 'em in there. The beavers have even started making a dam out of all the carts back there. If people get angry and ask you where all the carts are just say, "I'll check in the back." Or tell them they could use the exercise. They seem to respond well to this.

Now let me tell you a tip I learned about the lawn and garden department. You don't have to water plants if they're dead and conveniently the weed killer is right there, too. Once you've accidentally spilled weed killer in every plant the store owns, they'll have to order new ones, which will have been freshly watered by the supplier. You know what looks a lot like an inventory form from a distance? Photocopied Sudoku and crosswords. Get my drift? Ten-four. Just put down random numbers that sound good.

If you get an extra couple hundred boxes of kitty litter, oh well, somebody is gonna come into this store some time and that person will have a lot of cats. Until then, you have another excuse for you to take something into the back. Do you see these gloves? *(holds up hands)* You could hit a lot of dissatisfied customers with gloves like these. And guess where I got them… aisle thirteen. At some stores borrowing company property is frowned upon. Fortunately here is not some places. Here we'll just give you a big old MallMart smile. Our philosophy is "Hey, we do that. too." *(gives a shoulder nudge and wink)* Of course, if you ever want to avoid your co-workers, the best way to do it is by taking a stuffed animal cat, go in the middle of the store, wrap your arms tight and say, "Nice kitty mittens," over and over again. *(demonstrates)* People probably won't talk to you for months… or you'll be committed.

Have you ever seen a forklift full of vinegar collide into an aisle full of baking soda? Well, the result is pretty awesome. Try to make it happen at some point while you're working here. If you really find yourself without something to do, dump a gallon of apple juice outside the bathroom, the reactions are priceless, but nothing compared to the low, low prices we have here at MallMart. Have you seen the price on that TV in electronics? Of course the quality and service at MallMart are nothing compared to Jay Mart- uhhh, I mean, I love MallMart.

Why would I even mention Jay Mart? *(nervous laughter)* I certainly don't work there. It's not like I'm some sort of Jay Mart manager trying to knock out the competition by posing as a supervisor here and giving new employees terrible advice. *(nervous laughter continues)* Because that… that would just, just be ridiculous… uhhh, yeah, so just follow my advice and you'll be a successful MallMart employee in no time. Ummm, you can take the rest of the day off with full pay.